

Cesar Garcia

Founding Designer · Product Design Lead · Fintech, Payments, Crypto and AI

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Lisbon, Portugal · Remote across Europe · Portuguese (EU) citizen

SUMMARY

Twice a founding designer, an engineer by training, AI-native end to end: design, building, shipping. I turn high-stakes technical constraints into proven, unique, simple solutions, tuned to human behavior. Tripled a crypto checkout from 9% to 27%, adding \$135M a year in converted payments. Raised wallet signup completion from 12% to 88%, adding 20M users and saving \$6.9M a year. 200M+ users across payments, pensions, crypto, financial crime, consumer and SaaS.

SKILLS

Design	Design systems, Product strategy, User research, Prototyping, Information architecture, Design leadership and hiring, Data-led design, iOS, Android and web
Domains	Payments, Cryptocurrency and Web3, Digital wallets, KYC / AML, Financial crime compliance, Pensions, AI products
Tools	Figma, Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, AI-assisted prototyping and engineering

EXPERIENCE

Selected case studies at cesarxdesign.com ↗

Product Design Lead, Confirмо (Sep 2025 - Jul 2026) ↗

- Tripled checkout success from 9% to 27%, and 43% in key markets against a 24% industry average, adding \$135M a year in converted payments.
- Closed a \$680M a year drop-off that analytics could not locate, mapping every screen by hand and cross-reading support complaints against usage data.
- Traced the loss to the invoice trigger rather than the interface, and rebuilt the selection so customers could compare and preview before committing to anything irreversible.
- Launched Confirмо Subscriptions with Circle and Solana, the first recurring crypto payments product of its kind, moving the company to API-only enterprise clients.
- First designer at the company: built the component library and design system from scratch, owning checkout, merchant dashboard, brand and website.

Lead Product Designer, Trust Wallet (Apr 2025 - Sep 2025)

- Led onboarding for a self-custody crypto wallet with 200M users, arguing it into the banking and fiat squad to grow the fiat-native share.
- Reduced six import methods to a single routed decision that reads the wallet type from what the user pastes, a distinction the software could make and a newcomer could not.
- Overhauled the fiat-to-crypto funding flow for first-time buyers.

Staff Product Designer, BLKBOX.ai (Mar 2024 - Mar 2025)

- Opened the platform to the NFL for market-specific Super Bowl ads, by putting budget definition in the client's hands and letting the product run its live market bets itself.
- Encoded advertising craft into the AI generation engine as guardrails, teaching it how an ad should execute.
- Built the controls that made the platform self-serve and self-correcting.
- Delivered a full UX audit and user interview programme, mentoring another designer through it.

Head of Design and Product Owner, Mara (Nov 2022 - Feb 2024) ↗

- Raised signup completion from 12% to 88%, adding 20M users and saving \$6.9M a year, with acquisition running at 2.1M new users a month after launch.
- Cut onboarding from 27 screens to 8, after funnel analysis across 50,000 daily signups found seven major drop-offs.
- Moved KYC out of signup and into transactions, cutting third-party spend by \$5.7M.
- Delivered a full product redesign in under a month, standardising the six primary flows on one interaction pattern and replacing a bloated library, shipping to 24M users.
- Managed four designers, later adding engineering and customer support, and presented roadmap and growth strategy to the Coinbase-led investor group.

Founding Designer, Cable (Jul 2020 - Oct 2022) ↗

- Landed the product's first paid sale, turning a free pilot partner into a paying client and a pre-revenue pilot into a paid suite.
- Built Oversight as a second flagship, giving sponsor banks the same controls over the fintechs on their charter through one interface with different data.
- Restructured the product architecture around its record of accounts, reviewers and decisions; the account ID list became the most used component in the suite.
- Rebuilt the interface foundation when that work outgrew it, stripping out the navigation the whole structure hung on and redesigning every screen against the new model.
- Sole designer at a financial crime and AML compliance startup, designing to outcomes from weekly pilot-user research rather than transcribed workflows. Cable went on to 50+ banks and fintechs, and was later acquired by Synctera.

Founding Designer, Penfold (Jun 2019 - May 2020) ↗

- Drove signups from 100 to 600 a month by refocusing the product onto people with existing pensions, rebuilding it around combining the pots they already held rather than opening empty accounts.
- Turned the proof of concept into a live product in seven days, acquiring the first customers in time for the funding round.
- Restructured onboarding into five modules customers could leave and resume, turning users who quit midway into users who finished later, after session replays and weekly support reviews located the drop-off.
- Built one design system serving desktop and mobile, halving engineering load and letting the team ship daily.
- First hire on a 4-person team. Year one closed at 3,000 savers and £4M under management; Penfold now manages over £1B and was voted Best Pension 2026.

Head of Product Design, Starcount (Dec 2015 - May 2019) ↗

- Hit a £1M first-year revenue target in 91 days, turning three consultancy-only datasets into a self-serve product across two product lines launched from scratch and one revived.
- Redesigned the company's only product and launched a second on postcode delivery data, landing Twitter's first-ever data deal and Royal Mail on the back of both.
- Shaped the combined product from discovery across data, engineering, sales and client interviews: a live map of UK demand covering 1.7M postcodes and 27M households, refreshed by 20M UK tweets a day. Ran the prototype as the sales deck, growing the prospect list before launch.
- Rebalanced the projection with the data team so the map showed demand rather than population, after an accurate one put 90% of the visibility on London, and repurposed 3D extrusion from a mapping convention into a predictor of where demand was heading.
- Hired as Senior Product Designer, the company's first, and promoted to Head of Product Design; grew the function to five and managed four designers.

Designer, Leo Burnett (Sep 2013 - Oct 2015)

- Led the complete visual rebrand of Lisbon's commuter rail network.
- Designed across the Apple, Samsung, Mercedes and Vodafone accounts, and mentored incoming design interns.

Software Engineer, Pfizer (Jun 2006 - Dec 2012)

- Delivered a CRM migration with Accenture in the UK, managing the outsourced team against the Portugal specification.
- Designed an internal helpdesk tool later adopted across European branches.

EDUCATION

FLAG Design Academy, Communication Design (2012 - 2013)

Instituto Superior Técnico, Computer Science (2003 - 2006)